

The Important Dams of the World

A dam is a barrier used to hold back running water, thus creating a reservoir that can be used for irrigation, hydroelectricity generation, drinking water, etc. *The Parana River flows close to the borders of Brazil - Paraguay and Paraguay-Argentina **Itaipu Dam** has been constructed on this river which is a joint project of Brazil and Paraguay. It is 196 m high and 7919 m long. ***Aswan Dam** is located in Egypt on the Nile River. ***Hoover dam** which was earlier known as **Boulder Dam**, is a dam in the Black Canyon of the Colorado river, on the border between Arizona and Nevada. ***Kariba Dam** is a dam on the river Zambezi and creates a border between Zambia and Zimbabwe. ***Nurek Dam** is a dam on the Vakhsh river in Tajikistan. *The dam is located at a distance of 75 km from Dushanbe, the capital of Tajikistan. It is 300 m high. ***Grand Coulee dam** is a Dam on Columbia river in the USA. ***Cahora Bassa Dam** is a dam on the Zambezi river in the African country of Mozambique. ***Kurobe Dam** is an arch dam in Japan. It is constructed on the Kurobe river. ***Akosombo Dam** is also called the Volta Dam. It is constructed on the river Volta in the African country of Ghana. ***Grande Dixence Dam** is a dam on the Dexe river in Switzerland. It is 285 m high. ***Enguri Dam** is a dam on the Enguri river in Georgia (Europe). ***Vajont Dam** is a dam on the river Vajont in Italy. It is 262 m high. **Oroville Dam** is a dam on the Feather river in the USA. ***Xiaowan Dam** is a dam on the Lancang river (Lancang Jiang) (Mekong river) in China. It is an arch dam used for both hydroelectricity generation and irrigation. *China has constructed **Zangmu Dam** in Tibet on the Yarlung Zangbo River (Brahmaputra). Speculation are that it will slow down the flow of the river Brahmaputra.

1. **Itaipu Dam built on the river Parana is one of the largest dams in the world. Which of the following two countries have it as a joint project?**

(a) Brazil and Peru (b) Paraguay and Ecuador
(c) Brazil and Paraguay (d) Colombia and Paraguay

I.A.S. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (c)

Itaipu Dam is a joint venture between Brazil and Paraguay (both South American countries) at the border of Brazil and Paraguay border on the Parana river. The dam is 196 meters high and 7919 meters long.

2. **World's longest sea bridge has been built on -**

(a) East China Sea (b) Gulf of Tonkin
(c) Jiaozhou Bay (d) South China Sea

U.P. Lower Sub.(Pre) 2009

Ans. (c)

The One of the world's longest cross-sea bridges is built over Jiaozhou Bay. The bridge spans 41.58 km and connects the eastern coastal city of Qingdao to the suburb of Huangdao. It was opened to traffic on 30 June, 2011.

3. **Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer from the codes given below the lists:**

List-I	List-II
A. Colorado	1. Aswan
B. Damodar	2. Kariba
C. Nile	3. Panchet
D. Zambezi	4. Hoover

Code :

A	B	C	D
(a) 1	2	3	4
(b) 1	3	4	2
(c) 3	4	1	2
(d) 4	3	1	2

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2013

U.P.U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2013

Ans. (d)

The correctly matched pairs of rivers and dams are as follows:

(River)	(Dam)
Colorado	Hoover
Damodar	Panchet Hill
Nile	Aswan
Zambezi	Kariba

4. **Kariba dam has been built on the river:**

(a) Kafue (b) Zambezi
(c) Chambeshi (d) Kabompo

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (b)

Kariba dam, one of the largest dams in the world, is located on Zambezi River on Zambia-Zimbabwe border.

5. **The Aswan High Dam is located –**

(a) Sudan (b) Egypt
(c) Zaire (d) Nigeria

Jharkhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2013

Ans. (b)

The Aswan High Dam is located in Egypt on the African continent. It is built on the River Nile. Its water is used for irrigation of crops, and to generate hydroelectric power. Its construction started in 1960.

6. **The place where China has started construction of a dam on Brahmaputra River in Nov. 2010, is**

(a) Chingdu (b) Zangmu
(c) Zhuang (d) Gyangze

U.P.P.C.S.(Pre) 2013

Ans. (b)

The Zangmu Dam is a gravity dam on the Yarlung Zangbo/ Brahmaputra River in Tibet. The dam is expected to reduce the flow of the Brahmaputra River.